

FIFA World Cup 2026

Prediction Report

Stage: Round of 32

Run date: 2026-06-26 (report created: 2026-06-26)

Headline	Value
Title pick	Argentina (18.4%)
Most likely finalists	Argentina & Spain
Golden Boot pick	Lionel Messi (Argentina) – proj 7.7
Teams simulated	32
Monte Carlo runs	10,000

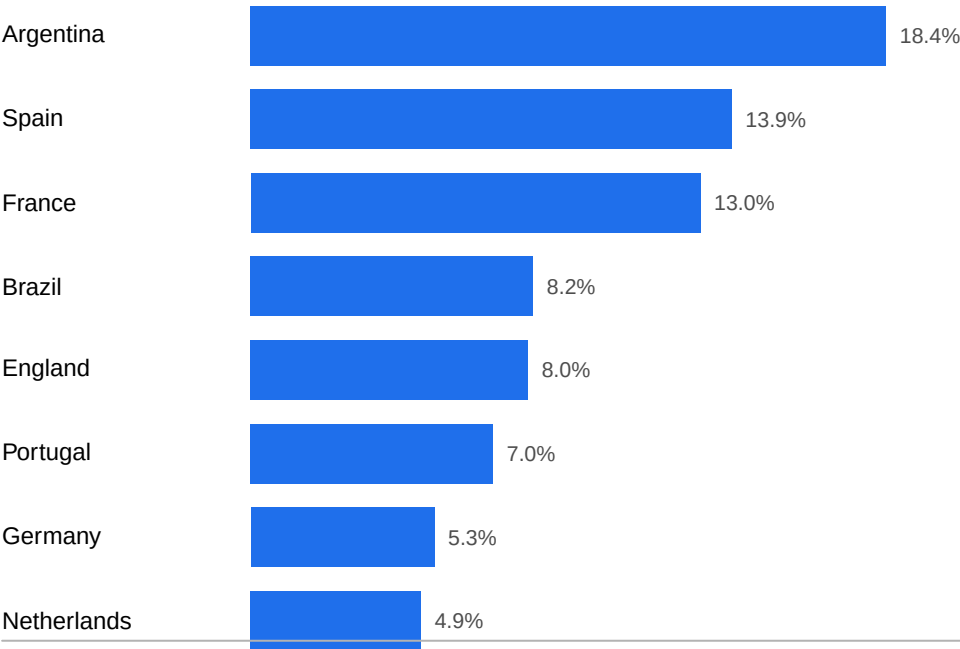
Model: ridge-shrunk Poisson (Dixon-Coles) goal model + Monte Carlo bracket simulation

Tournament Progression

As of 2026-06-26 – probabilities from 10,000 simulations

Team	R16	QF	SF	Final	Win
Argentina	86%	63%	47%	30%	18.4%
Spain	79%	56%	38%	24%	13.9%
France	77%	53%	36%	22%	13.0%
Brazil	69%	41%	27%	15%	8.2%
England	77%	57%	29%	16%	8.0%
Portugal	67%	51%	26%	14%	7.0%
Germany	71%	48%	23%	11%	5.3%
Netherlands	64%	32%	20%	10%	4.9%
USA	77%	31%	17%	8%	3.9%
Mexico	70%	30%	17%	8%	3.6%
Canada	63%	35%	13%	6%	2.2%
Belgium	62%	22%	12%	5%	1.9%
Colombia	63%	33%	12%	5%	1.8%
Switzerland	61%	26%	9%	3%	1.2%
Norway	33%	21%	7%	3%	0.8%
Morocco	36%	14%	7%	2%	0.8%

Title-winning probability



Round of 32 – Match Predictions

Advancer = win the tie; 90' result and likeliest score also shown

Match	Tie	Advance	90'	Score
South Africa v Switzerland	Confirmed	Switzerland (61%)	Away win	1–1 (13%)
Germany v Korea Republic *	Projected	Germany (71%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
Netherlands v Morocco	Confirmed	Netherlands (63%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
Brazil v Japan	Confirmed	Brazil (69%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
England v Bosnia and Herzegovina *	Projected	England (78%)	Home win	2–0 (11%)
Egypt v Scotland *	Projected	Egypt (60%)	Home win	1–1 (13%)
USA v Paraguay *	Projected	USA (76%)	Home win	2–1 (10%)
Spain v Austria *	Projected	Spain (79%)	Home win	2–0 (12%)
Canada v Ecuador *	Projected	Canada (62%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
Colombia v Sweden *	Projected	Colombia (62%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
Australia v Belgium *	Projected	Belgium (62%)	Away win	1–1 (14%)
Argentina v Cape Verde *	Projected	Argentina (86%)	Home win	2–0 (13%)
France v Senegal *	Projected	France (77%)	Home win	1–1 (11%)
Mexico v Cote d'Ivoire	Confirmed	Mexico (69%)	Home win	1–1 (11%)
Portugal v Norway *	Projected	Portugal (66%)	Home win	1–1 (12%)
Ghana v DR Congo *	Projected	Ghana (56%)	Home win	1–1 (14%)

* 12 tie(s) marked Projected use model–estimated participants (group stage not yet final / slot unconfirmed). Confirmed ties are locked from reported results. Update knockout_bracket.csv as matchups are confirmed and re–run.

Top-Scorer Forecast

Projected final goals = current + expected remaining

Golden Boot projection

Player	Team	Now	Exp+	Proj
Lionel Messi	Argentina	5	2.71	7.71
Kylian Mbappe	France	4	2.2	6.2
Vinicius Junior	Brazil	4	1.48	5.48
Erling Haaland	Norway	4	1.1	5.1
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	3	1.6	4.6
Jonathan David	Canada	3	1.59	4.59
Deniz Undav	Germany	3	1.29	4.29
Harry Kane	England	2	2.06	4.06
Julian Alvarez	Argentina	2	1.59	3.59
Christian Pulisic	USA	2	1.37	3.37
Alvaro Morata	Spain	2	1.27	3.27
Santiago Gimenez	Mexico	2	1.25	3.25

Top-scorer picks for Round of 32

Player	Team	Exp goals
Lionel Messi	Argentina	0.943
Harry Kane	England	0.815
Kylian Mbappe	France	0.797
Jonathan David	Canada	0.746
Christian Pulisic	USA	0.685
Mohamed Salah	Egypt	0.679
Cristiano Ronaldo	Portugal	0.619
Santiago Gimenez	Mexico	0.615

Recommendations & Method

How to play these predictions

STRATEGY: Back clear favourites where the model is confident (>60% advance)

to bank safe points; differentiate on tighter ties and on the Golden Boot,

where a well-placed contender on a deep team can outscore the favourite.

Model's title pick: Argentina (18.4%).

Champion pick: Argentina (18.4%). Safe R16 backers: Argentina, Spain,

England, USA, France, Germany.

Methodology

1. Team strength starts from Elo priors adjusted by researched form/injury notes.

2. A Dixon-Coles bivariate Poisson model turns strength into scoreline distributions;

parameters are refined by a ridge-penalised fit on observed results (shrinking to priors).

3. A Monte Carlo simulation plays out the bracket many times -> progression probabilities,

with extra time and strength-tilted penalty shootouts for knockout ties.

4. Each team's expected goals are shared among its players (form-adjusted) and weighted by

how far the team is projected to advance -> per-stage and Golden Boot scorer forecasts.

Data provenance

Verified: group draw, reported group winners, R32 anchor ties, Golden Boot tallies.

Illustrative/projected: unplayed scores and not-yet-confirmed bracket slots.

Refresh input_data/ CSVs with official data and re-run to update everything.